

### 8.1.4 Database

A system used to organise and store structured information for easy retrieval and manipulation. A database contains tables made up of rows and columns, and are used to store structured and hierarchical data like product details, employee information, etc. Databases today go beyond just storing textual information and can now store sound clips, pictures, and video too.

### 8.1.5 Digital

Information stored as a series of ones and zeroes is called digital information. Humans perceive information in analogue; digital devices estimate this information using ones and zeroes. This estimation, known as sampling, is the process of storing the information in a tiny slice of time. This could be several times per second, and while it is imperceptible to the human ear or eye, there is a tiny gap between two segments of information. A typical audio CD would be sampled at 44.1 KHz (44,100 samples per second) with a bit depth of 16 bits. This is a high-quality estimation of the audio signal, and provides a level of audio quality that sounds good to the ear. The major advantage with digital data is that it is much easier to copy, edit, and move without loss in quality.

### 8.1.7 End-user

The person who actually uses a software program. Among software developers, careful attention is paid to the wants and needs of the end-user when designing the program, as this person will either drive the adoption of the program or cause its downfall.

### 8.1.8 GUI (Graphical User Interface)

The graphical interface that we use with almost all computer systems these days. Before the GUI was invented, the way to interact with computer systems was through cryptic commands that were difficult for the ordinary user to remember or even understand. A GUI made life much easier, enabling people to use features like the dragging and dropping of objects with a mouse rather than enter text commands.